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K9 OPERATIONS

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES

Kikori Development Project (KDP) — Gulf Province, Papua New Guinea

Land Security • Border Security • Sea Marshal • Protective Security Detail

In support of the Papua LNG Project

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1.0 Purpose and Use of this SOP

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) translates the K9 Operations Policy (SCSH-SEC-K9-001, Version 3.0) into the step-by-step field actions required of handlers, senior handlers, the Kennel Master and supervising staff on the Kikori Development Project. The policy states what must be achieved and why; this SOP states how it is done, in what order, and by whom.

Where any conflict arises, the parent policy prevails. Where the parent policy or PNG law imposes a more stringent requirement than a step below, the more stringent requirement is followed. Nothing in this SOP authorises any act that is unlawful, disproportionate, or inconsistent with the Voluntary Principles on Security and Human Rights.

How the procedures are structured

Each numbered procedure (SOP-01 onwards) follows the same layout: a Purpose line, a Trigger line (when it applies), a Responsible line (who performs and who authorises), the ordered steps, and the Records generated. Handlers are expected to know the sequence of every SOP relevant to their tasking without reference to the document.

Golden rules — apply to every procedure below

A K9 is a controlled asset, never autonomous — positive handler control at all times. No deployment without a recorded authorisation. Any use of force is a last resort, proportionate, and stops the moment the threat ends. Welfare limits are mandatory and are never relaxed for operational tempo. Every action is recorded and attributable to a named person.

2.0 Roles Referenced in these Procedures

The following appointments carry the authorities used throughout this SOP. Full accountabilities are set out in Section 7 of the parent policy.

Appointment	Role in these procedures
Security Operations Manager (SOM)	Owns the capability at site; authorises high-risk, PSD and off-lead taskings; chairs incident reviews; reports to the client.
K9 Unit Supervisor (Kennel Master)	Day-to-day authority for kennels, welfare, training, certification currency, records and equipment; may tighten but never relax welfare limits.
Senior Handler	Shift supervision; pre-deployment quality control; authorises Level 3 controlled alert; first-line report check.
Handler	Sole operational custody of the assigned K9; performs the field steps; completes all logs; authorises Levels 1–2.
PSD Team Leader / Maritime Coordinator	Defines the task and threat picture; integrates the K9 team into the wider plan.
HSSE Manager	Assures safety; investigates bite/injury events; maintains bite-injury and zoonotic reporting.
Community Liaison Officer (CLO)	Community notification and awareness; receives K9-related grievances; advises on cultural sensitivities.
Attending Veterinarian	Clinical care; certifies fitness for duty; endorses welfare standards.

3.0 Part A — Daily and Routine Procedures

SOP-01

Daily Kennel and Welfare Routine

Purpose: Maintain the health, hygiene and condition of every K9 to the Five Domains standard before any operational tasking.

Trigger: Start of every day, and at each welfare check (minimum three times daily).

Responsible: Handler performs; Kennel Master verifies (daily initials, weekly signature).

1. Inspect the kennel: confirm it is dry, shaded, ventilated, free of flooding and free of vermin, snakes and pests. Clean and disinfect; record time and initials.
2. Check water: provide clean, cool drinking water; verify availability at each check.
3. Feed to the veterinarian-approved schedule. Do not feed within one hour before or after strenuous work (gastric-torsion risk). Record quantity and time.
4. Conduct a nose-to-tail check: body condition, gait, coat, eyes, ears, teeth, paws and pads. Record and escalate any tick, injury or abnormality.
5. Provide free-exercise and enrichment separate from formal training; record duration.
6. Observe behaviour and demeanour; record and report any change (reluctance to work, loss of drive, appetite change, stereotypic behaviour).
7. Inspect issued equipment (collar, lead, harness, muzzle, restraints); mark serviceable or defective. Withdraw any defective item immediately.
8. Sign the Daily Kennel and Welfare Log (Annex C). Any abnormality routes to the Kennel Master and, where clinical, the Attending Veterinarian.

Records: Annex C — Daily Kennel and Welfare Log.

SOP-02

Pre-Deployment Checks and Authorisation

Purpose: Confirm the K9, handler, equipment and authority are all in order before any team leaves for task.

Trigger: Before every deployment, without exception.

Responsible: Handler prepares; Senior Handler quality-checks; Deployment Authority authorises on Annex A.

9. Confirm handler fitness: not fatigued, unwell, or under impairing medication; no alcohol within the preceding 12 hours; drug/alcohol currency in order.
10. Confirm K9 fitness: current veterinary fitness-for-duty; certification current for the discipline tasked; no injury, lameness or behavioural flag.
11. Confirm certification currency against Annex D. A team whose certification has lapsed is NOT deployed (see SOP-20).
12. Inspect and sign for all equipment daily: collar, lead, harness, muzzle, vehicle restraint, comms with agreed call sign, GPS, torch.
13. Load the mandatory kit for every deployment: canine first-aid kit, cooling kit, and drinking water.
14. Record the ambient temperature and humidity at commencement; determine the applicable duty cycle from SOP-08.
15. Obtain authorisation: the Deployment Authority for the operational category completes and signs the K9 Deployment Authorisation Form (Annex A). No signature, no deployment.

Records: Annex A — K9 Deployment Authorisation Form; equipment register.

SOP-03

Transport of K9 (Road and River)

Purpose: Move K9s safely and humanely between the kennel block, forward bases and task locations.

Trigger: Any road or river movement of a K9.

Responsible: Handler; driver/coxswain in support.

16. Use only a purpose-built, ventilated, secured compartment or approved transport cage. Open trays, unsecured cargo areas and passenger footwells are prohibited.
17. Confirm shade and ventilation before loading; check the compartment is not heat-trapped.
18. Offer water at intervals not exceeding two hours; on river movement confirm flotation availability.
19. Never leave a stationary vehicle carrying a K9 without ventilation, shade AND a person in attendance.
20. Record journey start, water stops and duration on the deployment log.

Records: Deployment log (journey duration and water intervals).

4.0 Part B — Operational Deployment Procedures

SOP-04

Land Security Patrol and Search

Purpose: Detect intrusion, deter approach and screen access across compounds, laydown yards, construction areas and the pipeline right-of-way.

Trigger: Tasked land patrol, gate/access screening, or post-incident search.

Responsible: Handler; Senior Handler supervises; SOM authorises emergency-response support.

21. Complete SOP-02 pre-deployment and receive the task brief: area, threat picture, boundaries and rules of engagement.
22. For patrol: work bush-line sweeps, tracking or compound protection under positive control. Conduct night patrols in pairs, with lighting and comms confirmed.
23. For access screening: run detection K9s over vehicles, cargo, baggage and personnel at gates using the passive-indication method.
24. On any detection indication, apply SOP-07 (do not touch, secure the item and area, summon the appropriate authority).
25. Observe the heat/fatigue duty cycle (SOP-08) throughout; rotate to rest on schedule.
26. For emergency-response support during disturbance, tension or attempted sabotage: deploy only on the express authority of the SOM and strictly within Section 13 use-of-force limits.
27. Record the deployment outcome (detections, deterrence, nil) on Annex A and close out.

SOP-05

Border and Checkpoint Screening

Purpose: Screen boats, convoys, foot groups and cargo entering or leaving KDP zones, and interdict contraband.

Trigger: Tasked checkpoint duty or river/track screening.

Responsible: Handler; supported by the checkpoint team; statutory authority summoned for seizure/arrest.

28. Establish the checkpoint or screening line at the tasked river, track or access route with the escorting security element.
29. Screen boats, convoys, foot patrol groups and cargo for weapons, explosives, narcotics, contraband and wildlife-trafficking material.
30. On a detection indication, apply SOP-07. Do NOT exercise search, seizure or arrest powers — these are reserved to statutory authorities.
31. Secure the item and the immediate area; preserve it; summon the RPNGC or other appropriate authority; record time of the request.
32. For any joint operation with community leaders, provincial authorities or government agencies, confirm the documented liaison arrangement is in place before proceeding.
33. Record all indications, interdictions and handovers on Annex A.

SOP-06

Sea Marshal Vessel Sweep and Maritime Deployment

Purpose: Screen vessels for weapons and explosives and support boarding, escort and anti-piracy tasks.

Trigger: Pre-departure sweep, escort or maritime interdiction tasking.

Responsible: Handler; integrated under the Sea Marshal; Maritime Coordinator tasks.

Mandatory before any maritime deployment

Canine flotation device fitted; specialised lifting harness carried; a rehearsed dog-overboard recovery plan briefed; shaded rest space identified; and an uninterrupted supply of fresh drinking water aboard. No maritime task begins until all five are confirmed.

34. Confirm the five maritime prerequisites above and complete SOP-02.

35. Conduct the pre-departure vessel sweep for weapons and explosives before personnel embark where practicable.
36. Search cargo holds, containers, cabins, machinery spaces and fuel compartments ONLY after confined-space atmosphere clearance (see SOP-09).
37. Integrate into the ship boarding team under the direction of the Sea Marshal; maintain positive control on deck and gangway.
38. Apply the heat/fatigue cycle (SOP-08); rotate the K9 to the shaded rest space; offer water at each rotation.
39. On indication, apply SOP-07. Record the sweep result and any recovery on Annex A.

SOP-07**Detection Indication Response**

Purpose: Standardise the safe, lawful response to a K9 indication on a target odour.

Trigger: A detection K9 gives a trained passive indication.

Responsible: Handler; statutory authority for any search/seizure/arrest.

40. Read and confirm the indication; reward and reposition the K9 to a safe stand-off. Do NOT allow the K9 or any person to disturb the item.
41. Establish a cordon around the item and area; keep people clear; treat as potentially hazardous until cleared.
42. Notify the checkpoint/team leader and, for suspected explosives, initiate the site EOD/threat-item response and evacuate to safe distance.
43. Summon the appropriate statutory authority (RPNGC or as directed). Do not conduct search, seizure or arrest yourself.
44. Preserve the scene and any evidence; collect witness details; hand over to the authority and record the time.
45. Log the indication, outcome and handover on Annex A; report deterrence/interdiction outcomes under SOP-15.

SOP-08a**PSD Advance Sweep and Escort**

Purpose: Screen venues, routes and movements for a protected principal and preserve stand-off during moves.

Trigger: Advance-sweep or principal-movement tasking.

Responsible: Handler; PSD Team Leader tasks; SOM authorises the PSD tasking.

46. Confirm only a passive-indication detection K9 of stable temperament is assigned — patrol/apprehension dogs are not used near principals or the public.
47. Receive the threat picture and site brief from the PSD Team Leader; complete SOP-02.
48. Conduct advance sweeps of venues, routes, accommodation, meeting rooms, vehicles, gifts, freight and delegate baggage for explosives and concealed weapons.
49. Declare areas swept and maintain sterility; control re-entry.
50. On escort, position to preserve a defined crowd buffer / stand-off from the principal and the public; avoid accidental contact.
51. On indication, apply SOP-07 and initiate protective response as briefed. Record on Annex A.

5.0 Part C — Heat, Use of Force and Incidents

SOP-08

Heat, Fatigue and Duty-Cycle Management

Purpose: Prevent heat injury and fatigue in the tropical Gulf Province climate.

Trigger: Every deployment; re-checked whenever conditions change.

Responsible: Handler applies; Kennel Master may tighten (never relax) the limits.

Read the ambient temperature/humidity at commencement (SOP-02) and apply the mandatory cycle:

Condition	Max continuous work	Mandatory rest and control
Below 28°C	45 minutes	15 min shaded rest; water offered
28°C – 32°C	30 minutes	30 min shaded rest; water + body-temp check
Above 32°C or humidity > 85%	15 minutes	45 min shade/cooled space; active cooling; deployment reviewed by Kennel Master
Night operations	45 minutes	15 min rest; lighting + comms confirmed

- Total operational working time must not exceed 6 hours in any 24-hour period (excluding rest and transit).
- Each K9 receives at least one full rest day in every seven.
- **Heat-stress signs** — excessive panting, unsteady gait, bright-red or pale gums, vomiting, collapse — require IMMEDIATE stop, active cooling and veterinary notification (see SOP-13).

SOP-09

Confined-Space and Hazard-Area Entry

Purpose: Prevent injury to the K9 team when searching enclosed or hazardous spaces.

Trigger: Any search of a hold, container, machinery space, fuel compartment or confined/hazard area.

Responsible: Handler; permit issuer; SOM for written risk assessment on high-hazard areas.

- Do NOT allow K9 entry to a confined space without atmospheric testing, a valid permit, and an extraction plan.
- For known unexploded ordnance, chemical contamination, unstable structures or active fire: do not deploy without a specific written risk assessment authorised by the SOM.
- Confirm the canine first-aid and cooling kits are on hand and the extraction route is clear before entry.
- Limit exposure time; monitor the K9 continuously; withdraw at the first sign of distress.
- Record the permit reference and clearance on Annex A.

SOP-10

Use of Force and K9 Apprehension

Purpose: Ensure any apprehension is lawful, proportionate, authorised at the correct level, and ceases the moment the threat ends.

Trigger: A threat that may require escalation beyond controlled presence.

Responsible: Handler / Senior Handler / SOM per the level applied.

Governing principle

Deploying a patrol K9 to apprehend is a USE OF FORCE. Use the lowest level reasonably necessary, for the shortest time necessary. Off-lead deployment (Level 5) is permitted ONLY in defence of life where no reasonable alternative exists, and must be authorised by the SOM and recorded contemporaneously.

Level	K9 application	Authorisation
1	Presence — leashed, controlled, no verbal challenge	Handler
2	Verbal warning with K9 present, in a language understood by the subject where practicable	Handler

Level	K9 application	Authorisation
3	Controlled alert — barking on lead to induce compliance	Senior Handler
4	Deployment on lead to apprehend a person posing a serious threat	Security Operations Manager or delegate
5	Off-lead deployment — defence of life only, no reasonable alternative	SOM, recorded contemporaneously

Prohibited uses — never permitted

- Against children, visibly pregnant women, the elderly or persons with evident disability, except in immediate defence of life.
- Against a person who has surrendered, is restrained, is compliant, or is fleeing without posing a threat of serious harm.
- For punishment, coercion, crowd dispersal, or to extract information.
- Against a peaceful assembly, lawful protest or landowner gathering.
- In any manner intended to humiliate a person or to exploit cultural sensitivities.

SOP-11 Post-Bite and Post-Use-of-Force Actions

Purpose: Protect life, preserve evidence and meet reporting duties immediately after any bite or use of force.

Trigger: Any bite, apprehension, or accidental contact — whether or not injury results.

Responsible: Handler first; Senior Handler / SOM / HSSE / vet as below.

57. Render immediate first aid to any person bitten; arrange professional medical treatment without delay and at Company cost where liability may attach.

58. Regain and secure positive control of the K9; remove it from the immediate scene.

59. Preserve the scene; retain body-worn and CCTV footage; collect witness names and contact details.

60. Notify the SOM verbally without delay.

61. Stand the K9 team down from operational duty pending review.

62. Arrange veterinary assessment of the K9 and a behavioural review by the Kennel Master.

63. Submit the written K9 Bite and Use of Force Report (Annex B) within 12 hours.

64. Ensure the client and, where required, the relevant PNG authority are notified; record time and person.

Records: Annex B — K9 Bite and Use of Force Report; HSSE bite-injury register.

6.0 Part D — Welfare, Health, Community and Biosecurity

SOP-12

New-Arrival Onboarding, Quarantine and Acclimatisation

Purpose: Bring a new K9 safely into the unit, clear biosecurity, and condition it to the environment before tasking.

Trigger: Arrival of any new or transferred K9.

Responsible: Kennel Master; Attending Veterinarian; handler.

65. Confirm NAQIA import, quarantine and certification requirements are met before movement into or within PNG.
66. Place the K9 in the quarantine/isolation kennel for the prescribed health-observation period before it enters the operational block.
67. Record the dog on the K9 asset register: identity, microchip, discipline, certification status, handler assignment, medical history, service status.
68. Complete a documented acclimatisation period of not less than 14 days for tropical heat, humidity, terrain and site conditions before any operational employment.
69. Complete a documented temperament assessment (noise, crowds, vessel/helicopter movement, livestock neutrality, child presence) and pair with a primary handler.
70. Release to duty only on veterinary fitness-for-duty and current certification.

SOP-13

Illness, Injury and Veterinary Withdrawal

Purpose: Remove an unfit K9 from duty promptly and route it to care.

Trigger: Any injury, lameness, heat stress, GI illness, or behavioural change.

Responsible: Handler; Kennel Master; Attending Veterinarian.

71. Stop work immediately on any sign of heat stress; apply active cooling and notify the veterinarian.
72. Withdraw the K9 from duty pending veterinary assessment for any injury, lameness, GI illness or behavioural change.
73. Record the condition in the individual health file; escalate to the Kennel Master.
74. For serious injury, activate the documented canine medical-evacuation route to the retained emergency veterinary capability.
75. Return to duty only on a veterinary fitness-for-duty certificate.

SOP-14

Conduct In and Near Communities

Purpose: Prevent community grievance and respect cultural sensitivities during K9 activity.

Trigger: Any operation within, or transit of, a village, market, church, school or gathering place.

Responsible: Handler; CLO advises and notifies.

76. Confirm the CLO has briefed landowner leadership on the purpose, limits and control of the K9 capability before it enters any new area.
77. Leash and, where appropriate, muzzle the K9 whenever operating within or transiting a community space.
78. Do NOT deploy K9s at community meetings, negotiations, compensation payments, ILG meetings or grievance forums.
79. Route patrols to avoid contact between Company K9s and community dogs, pigs, poultry and other livestock.
80. Do not photograph community members with K9s without informed consent.
81. Record any cultural objection raised; refer to the SOM and CLO for review before further deployment at that location.

Heightened-sensitivity periods (Development Forum / benefit-sharing)

During the Development Forum process, benefit or royalty distribution, ILG registration or elevated landowner dispute, the SOM reviews and may reduce, re-route or suspend routine K9 tasking. K9 teams are NOT deployed at or near forums, benefit/royalty payments, ILG meetings, compensation events or protests. The K9 capability is not a crowd-control or dispute-resolution instrument. Each decision to deploy, restrict or suspend is recorded with its rationale.

SOP-15**Incident Reporting, Investigation and Grievances**

Purpose: Ensure every reportable event is captured, escalated and investigated to time.

Trigger: Any reportable event (see list below).

Responsible: Handler reports; SOM/HSSE investigate; CLO handles community grievances.

Reportable events include: aggression or loss of control; any bite, scratch or accidental contact; injury, illness, escape or death of a K9; equipment failure affecting control or safety; missed refresher training or lapsed certification; handler misconduct or suspected mistreatment; training-aid discrepancies; and operational outcomes (detections, interdictions, recoveries, deterrence).

Stage	Timeframe
Immediate verbal notification — bite, serious injury, escape, death	Without delay
Written report submitted	Within 12 hours
Formal investigation commenced (bite or welfare breach)	Within 24 hours
Investigation concluded	Within 7 days
Findings, corrective actions and lessons circulated to all K9 staff	Within 14 days
Community grievance acknowledged (via KDP grievance mechanism)	Within 48 hours
Community grievance resolved (or documented extension)	Within 21 days

- Any injury to a community member or their livestock triggers immediate medical/veterinary assistance at Company cost, investigation, notification to client and landowner leadership, and compensation consideration under the KDP framework and PNG law.
- Concealment or non-reporting of a bite, injury or welfare breach is gross misconduct (see SOP-21).

7.0 Part E — Training, Assurance and End of Service

SOP-16

Control of Explosive and Narcotic Training Aids

Purpose: Account for every training aid and prevent loss, diversion or unlawful storage.

Trigger: Any issue, use, return or disposal of a training aid.

Responsible: Handler/trainer; Kennel Master reconciles weekly; SOM reconciles monthly.

82. Store aids only in approved, segregated, alarmed, access-controlled containers held under the relevant PNG regulator's authority. Never in accommodation, vehicles, kennel blocks or unsecured offices.
83. Record every issue, return, consumption and disposal in the dual-signature register.
84. Reconcile the register weekly (Kennel Master) and monthly (SOM).
85. Report any discrepancy IMMEDIATELY as a security incident (SOP-15) and notify the relevant authority.

SOP-17

Training and Certification Currency

Purpose: Keep every team certified, current and operationally reliable.

Trigger: Ongoing — weekly, quarterly and annual cycles.

Responsible: Senior Handler / Kennel Master / Attending Veterinarian / assessors per Annex D.

86. Deliver at least 8 hours of structured refresher training per team per week; record in the training log.
87. Run quarterly competency assessment (Kennel Master) against the certification standard held.
88. Run blind / double-blind detection validation at least quarterly; retain results as reliability evidence (target $\geq 95\%$).
89. Arrange annual external re-certification by an accredited independent assessor.
90. Track all currencies against the Certification and Currency Matrix (Annex D); flag any item approaching expiry.

SOP-18

Loss or Lapse of Certification

Purpose: Prevent deployment of any uncertified team.

Trigger: A failed assessment or a lapsed certification.

Responsible: Kennel Master; SOM informed.

91. Withdraw the team from operational duty IMMEDIATELY.
92. Record the lapse/failure and notify the SOM (deployment of an uncertified team is a serious disciplinary matter).
93. Deliver remedial training and re-assess.
94. Restore to duty only after a documented successful re-assessment.

SOP-19

Retirement, Rehoming and End of Service

Purpose: Retire and rehome K9s humanely and accountably.

Trigger: Annual fitness review from age 7, or veterinary advice at any time.

Responsible: Kennel Master; Attending Veterinarian; SOM authorises euthanasia.

95. Review fitness for continued service annually from age 7, and at any time on veterinary advice.
96. Retire on grounds of age, chronic injury, loss of drive, sustained failure to certify, or veterinary recommendation.
97. Offer the retiring handler first option to adopt, subject to a home-suitability assessment.
98. Where the handler cannot adopt, rehome to a screened, approved home or a recognised working-dog retirement organisation.

99. Consider euthanasia ONLY on veterinary advice for irremediable suffering or unmanageable danger, with written SOM authorisation and a written veterinary opinion.

Absolutely prohibited

Abandonment, sale for fighting or baiting, transfer to an unassessed party, or informal disposal of a Company K9 by any means. Any such act is gross misconduct.

SOP-20 Records, Assurance and Audit Readiness

Purpose: Maintain complete, retrievable, audit-ready records and meet performance targets.

Trigger: Continuous; monthly and quarterly reporting.

Responsible: Kennel Master (monthly); SOM (quarterly); independent auditors.

100. Maintain in retrievable form: the asset register, individual health/veterinary files, training and certification records, daily deployment and welfare logs, incident and investigation files, and training-aid registers.
101. Retain records for at least 7 years, or the life of the dog plus 3 years, whichever is longer; produce on lawful request.
102. Report monthly (Kennel Master) and quarterly (SOM) against the performance indicators below.
103. Support internal audit at least every 6 months (independent of the unit) and annual external audit of welfare, certification and use-of-force compliance; the client may audit at any time on reasonable notice.

Performance indicator	Target
Certification currency across all teams	100%
Weekly refresher training hours	≥ 8 hrs per team
Blind detection trial success rate	≥ 95%
Bite incidents involving community members	Zero
Welfare breaches recorded	Zero
Veterinary exams completed on schedule	100%
Incident reports submitted within 12 hours	100%
K9-related grievances resolved within 21 days	≥ 95%
PNG national handlers as a proportion of the unit	Increasing year on year
SOP-21 Non-Compliance and Disciplinary Escalation	

Purpose: Ensure breaches are escalated and managed under the Zero-Tolerance policy.

Trigger: Any suspected breach of this SOP or the parent policy.

Responsible: Any staff member reports; SOM/HSSE and HR act.

The following are treated as gross misconduct and may result in summary dismissal, removal from PNG and referral to PNG authorities under the Conduct, Ethics and Prohibited Behaviour Policy (SCSH-HR-GOV-001):

- Cruelty, neglect, or punitive/aversive handling methods.
- Unauthorised or unlawful deployment of a K9 against a person.
- Falsification of training, welfare, certification, deployment or incident records.
- Loss, theft, diversion or unaccounted consumption of explosive or narcotic training aids.
- Deployment of a K9 while impaired by alcohol or drugs.
- Concealment or non-reporting of a bite, injury or welfare breach.

8.0 Annex — Quick-Reference Field Card

This card summarises the non-negotiables. It does not replace the full procedures above.

Before every deployment (SOP-02)

- Handler fit • K9 fit • certification current • equipment signed • first-aid + cooling kit + water • temp/humidity read • Annex A signed.

Heat cycle (SOP-08)

- <28°C: 45 min work / 15 rest • 28–32°C: 30 / 30 + temp check • >32°C or >85% humidity: 15 / 45 + active cooling + Kennel Master review • Night: 45 / 15.
- Max 6 hrs work per 24 hrs • 1 rest day in 7 • heat-stress signs = STOP, cool, call vet.

Use of force ladder (SOP-10)

- 1 Presence (Handler) • 2 Verbal warning (Handler) • 3 Controlled alert (Senior Handler) • 4 On-lead apprehension (SOM) • 5 Off-lead — defence of life only (SOM, recorded now).

On a detection indication (SOP-07)

- Don't touch • cordon • notify • summon the authority • preserve evidence • log on Annex A.

After any bite (SOP-11)

- First aid → secure K9 → preserve scene/footage → notify SOM → stand down → vet + behavioural review → Annex B within 12 hrs → notify client/authority.

Never

- Never deploy uncertified. Never against children/pregnant/elderly/disabled except defence of life. Never at forums, payments, protests or grievance forums. Never for punishment, coercion or crowd dispersal. Never leave a K9 in an unattended vehicle without shade and ventilation.

Forms in use: Annex A — Deployment Authorisation • Annex B — Bite / Use of Force Report • Annex C — Daily Kennel & Welfare Log • Annex D — Certification & Currency Matrix (as set out in the parent policy).

END OF SOP